My Bird Spotting Trip Log

Observe first, identify second. The best birdwatchers notice details.

Name: _____ **Age:** _____

Place: _____ **Date:** _____

Start time: _____ **End time:** _____

Weather: ☐ Sunny ☐ Cloudy ☐ Rainy ☐ Windy ☐ Cool ☐ Hot

What should I notice?

Feature	Questions to ask
Size	Sparrow-sized? Myna-sized? Crow-sized? Bigger than a crow?
Colour & markings	What are the main colours? Any eye stripe, wing patch, spots, bars, crest, white rump or coloured throat?
Beak / bill	Short and seed-crushing? Thin and curved? Long and spear-like? Hooked like a raptor?
Tail	Long or short? Forked, square, rounded or fan-shaped? Does it wag or spread?
Legs & feet	Long wading legs? Strong claws? Webbed feet? What colour are the legs?
Flight	Fast and direct? Flap-flap-glide? Soaring? Hovering? Low over water? Neck stretched or folded?
Behaviour	Perching, fishing, probing mud, catching insects, feeding on fruit, chasing another bird, preening, nesting?
Habitat	Water, reedbed, open field, tree canopy, garden, wire, rooftop, forest edge?
Sound	Whistle, harsh call, repeated note, musical song? Write the sound in your own words.

> **Good science habit:** If you are unsure, write “unknown bird” or “raptor sp.” and describe what you saw. A careful unknown is better than a confident wrong ID.

Quick trip tally

☐ Waterbird ☐ Kingfisher ☐ Egret / heron ☐ Stork ☐ Duck ☐ Bee-eater ☐ Myna ☐ Bulbul ☐ Koel ☐ Sunbird ☐ Raptor ☐ Vulture

Detailed sightings 1-4

Sighting 1

Bird / guess: _____ **Time / place:** _____

Size	□ sparrow □ myna □ crow □ larger
Main colours	_____
Head / face marks	_____
Beak	□ short □ long □ curved □ hooked □ other
Tail	□ short □ long □ forked □ rounded □ square
Legs / feet	_____
Flight	□ direct □ soaring □ hovering □ flap-glide □ low over water
Habitat / perch	_____
Eating / feeding	_____
Behaviour	_____
Call / sound	_____
How many?	_____ □ alone □ pair □ small flock □ large flock
What helped me ID it?	_____

Quick sketch - mark the colour patches, bill shape, tail and any special feature.

Sighting 2

Bird / guess: _____ **Time / place:** _____

Size	□ sparrow □ myna □ crow □ larger
Main colours	_____
Head / face marks	_____
Beak	□ short □ long □ curved □ hooked □ other
Tail	□ short □ long □ forked □ rounded □ square
Legs / feet	_____
Flight	□ direct □ soaring □ hovering □ flap-glide □ low over water
Habitat / perch	_____
Eating / feeding	_____
Behaviour	_____
Call / sound	_____
How many?	_____ □ alone □ pair □ small flock □ large flock
What helped me ID it?	_____

Quick sketch - mark the colour patches, bill shape, tail and any special feature.

Sighting 3

Bird / guess: _____ **Time / place:** _____

Size	□ sparrow □ myna □ crow □ larger
Main colours	_____
Head / face marks	_____
Beak	□ short □ long □ curved □ hooked □ other
Tail	□ short □ long □ forked □ rounded □ square
Legs / feet	_____
Flight	□ direct □ soaring □ hovering □ flap-glide □ low over water
Habitat / perch	_____
Eating / feeding	_____
Behaviour	_____
Call / sound	_____
How many?	_____ □ alone □ pair □ small flock □ large flock
What helped me ID it?	_____

Quick sketch - mark the colour patches, bill shape, tail and any special feature.

Sighting 4

Bird / guess: _____ **Time / place:** _____

Size	□ sparrow □ myna □ crow □ larger
Main colours	_____
Head / face marks	_____
Beak	□ short □ long □ curved □ hooked □ other
Tail	□ short □ long □ forked □ rounded □ square
Legs / feet	_____
Flight	□ direct □ soaring □ hovering □ flap-glide □ low over water
Habitat / perch	_____
Eating / feeding	_____
Behaviour	_____
Call / sound	_____
How many?	_____ □ alone □ pair □ small flock □ large flock
What helped me ID it?	_____

Quick sketch - mark the colour patches, bill shape, tail and any special feature.

Detailed sightings 5-8

Sighting 5

Bird / guess: _____ **Time / place:** _____

Size	□ sparrow □ myna □ crow □ larger
Main colours	_____
Head / face marks	_____
Beak	□ short □ long □ curved □ hooked □ other
Tail	□ short □ long □ forked □ rounded □ square
Legs / feet	_____
Flight	□ direct □ soaring □ hovering □ flap-glide □ low over water
Habitat / perch	_____
Eating / feeding	_____
Behaviour	_____
Call / sound	_____
How many?	_____ □ alone □ pair □ small flock □ large flock
What helped me ID it?	_____

Quick sketch - mark the colour patches, bill shape, tail and any special feature.

Sighting 6

Bird / guess: _____ **Time / place:** _____

Size	□ sparrow □ myna □ crow □ larger
Main colours	_____
Head / face marks	_____
Beak	□ short □ long □ curved □ hooked □ other
Tail	□ short □ long □ forked □ rounded □ square
Legs / feet	_____
Flight	□ direct □ soaring □ hovering □ flap-glide □ low over water
Habitat / perch	_____
Eating / feeding	_____
Behaviour	_____
Call / sound	_____
How many?	_____ □ alone □ pair □ small flock □ large flock
What helped me ID it?	_____

Quick sketch - mark the colour patches, bill shape, tail and any special feature.

Sighting 7

Bird / guess: _____ **Time / place:** _____

Size	□ sparrow □ myna □ crow □ larger
Main colours	_____
Head / face marks	_____
Beak	□ short □ long □ curved □ hooked □ other
Tail	□ short □ long □ forked □ rounded □ square
Legs / feet	_____
Flight	□ direct □ soaring □ hovering □ flap-glide □ low over water
Habitat / perch	_____
Eating / feeding	_____
Behaviour	_____
Call / sound	_____
How many?	_____ □ alone □ pair □ small flock □ large flock
What helped me ID it?	_____

Quick sketch - mark the colour patches, bill shape, tail and any special feature.

Sighting 8

Bird / guess: _____ **Time / place:** _____

Size	□ sparrow □ myna □ crow □ larger
Main colours	_____
Head / face marks	_____
Beak	□ short □ long □ curved □ hooked □ other
Tail	□ short □ long □ forked □ rounded □ square
Legs / feet	_____
Flight	□ direct □ soaring □ hovering □ flap-glide □ low over water
Habitat / perch	_____
Eating / feeding	_____
Behaviour	_____
Call / sound	_____
How many?	_____ □ alone □ pair □ small flock □ large flock
What helped me ID it?	_____

Quick sketch - mark the colour patches, bill shape, tail and any special feature.

Quick sightings list

Use this page for birds you saw but did not make a full observation card for.

#	Bird / unknown	Where seen	Best field mark	What it was doing	Count
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					
9					
10					
11					
12					
13					
14					
15					
16					
17					
18					
19					
20					

My trip reflection

Favourite bird

Bird I want to learn more about

Most surprising behaviour

Something I noticed about the habitat

Sketch my best sighting

Add arrows to the field marks that helped you identify it.

Total different birds I saw: _____ **Total raptors:** _____